

SECTION 13. *Seniors and Driving*

Senior drivers often have unique needs and concerns about driving. Driving requires certain physical, visual, and mental abilities. We all want to continue driving as long as we can. However, the time may come when we must limit or stop driving temporarily or permanently. Here are some warning signs of an unsafe driver:

- Getting lost in familiar places.
- Dents and scrapes on the car, fences, mailbox, garage doors, etc.
- Frequent close calls or collisions.

Senior drivers may consider:

- Limiting or not driving at night.
 - If night driving is necessary, choose a well-lit route.
- Driving during the time of day when traffic is light.
- Avoiding difficult intersections.
- Driving for short distances or limiting driving to essential places.
- No freeway driving.
- Installing an additional right-side mirror.

To get the Driver Skills Self-Assessment Questionnaire, visit **dmv.ca.gov/driver-skills**.

Driver's License Renewal

If you are 70 years old or older at the time your driver's license expires, you are required to renew your driver's license in person and pass a vision test. In some cases, other exams may be required. If a knowledge test is required, you may be eligible to select "eLearning" when completing your application online. DMV sends a renewal notice to your address of record about 90 days before your driver's license expires. If you do not receive a renewal notice, complete a Driver License or Identification Card Application at **dmv.ca.gov/dlservices** or at a DMV office. Visit **dmv.ca.gov/driver-ed** for more information and sample tests.

DMV's Community Liaison and Outreach

The Community Liaison's primary function is to represent public safety interests for all Californians, with a focus in addressing the concerns of senior drivers and teens. The liaison can assist as a go-between to ensure drivers are treated fairly, consistently with laws and regulations, and with dignity and respect. While the Community Liaison cannot represent you in a DMV hearing or reexamination, they can provide you with useful tools and information.